

Comprehension/Analysis Questions for *Oedipus Rex*, by Sophocles

ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS ON YOUR OWN PAPER...

1. Oedipus is the king of which city?
2. What message does Creon bring from the oracle at Delphi?
3. Who is Laius?
4. Name the five gods/goddesses that the Chorus members pray to. Why would they pray to these particular gods/goddesses?
5. What is Oedipus' response to the Chorus' prayer?
6. Who is Tiresias?
7. Why does Tiresias wish to stay silent about the murderer's identity?
8. How is Tiresias' blindness ironic?
9. Why is Oedipus angry with Creon?
10. Does Creon want to be king? What are his reasons for this?
11. Summarize the story that Jocasta tells Oedipus.
12. Describe Laius.
13. Summarize the story that Oedipus tells Jocasta.
14. What news does the messenger from Corinth bring?
15. Why does the messenger say that he and King Polybus are equals to Oedipus?
16. What do Oedipus' ankles reveal?
17. Why doesn't Jocasta want Oedipus to send for the shepherd?
18. Why is the shepherd reluctant to tell where he got the baby?

19. Why was the baby given to the shepherd?
20. What does Jocasta do as a result of her realization of the truth?
21. What does Oedipus do?
22. Why does Oedipus do this? What reason does he give?
23. What request does Oedipus make of Creon?
24. Who are Oedipus' daughters?
25. How does Creon punish Oedipus? Do you think Creon is fair to Oedipus?

Now that you have completed the play, **analyze the character of Oedipus as a tragic hero (provide line numbers):**

1. Greatness =
2. Tragic flaw =
3. Moment of realization =
4. Suffering =

Brainstorm ideas to answer this question: **Who is to blame for the tragedy that befalls Oedipus?**